

COMPARISON · GRID · STRUCTURE

# verdict-grid

Options scored against criteria as a verdict matrix.

# The grid scores options against shared criteria.

**Option one.**

-  Criterion
-  Criterion

Why the checks land this way.

**Option two.**

-  Criterion
-  Criterion

Unknown is not a no.

**Option three.**



-  Criterion
-  Criterion

The sweep is the verdict. Recommended.

# Five options is the verdict grid's ceiling.

**First.**

 Check  Check

Early cards set the criteria order.

**Second.**

 Check  Check

Partial marks keep the grid honest.

**Third.**

 Check  Check

The middle card is read most carefully.

**Fourth.**

 Check  Check

Late cards inherit the reader's fatigue.

**Fifth.**

 Check  Check

The hard stop; six wants table.



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# When NOT to reach for verdict-grid.

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## Exactly two options

Two options with shared criteria belong in `compare-prose` or `split-compare`. verdict-grid earns its layout at 3+ options.

## No rationale line

Every option must end with a marker-less prose line — the verdict for that card. Omit it and the card renders empty below the badges, and the focal last card has nothing to recommend. The rationale is required, not optional.

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## Badge longer than two words

The text after the marker is a badge, not a sentence — two words at most ( `Residency` , `Self-serve` ). A sentence on a badge line breaks the row scan; prose belongs only on the final rationale line.

## Cards with different criteria

When each option needs its own criteria list, the comparison fails — use `cards-stack` so each card has full prose breathing room instead.

RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`compare-prose` — exactly two options with prose bodies

`split-compare` — two options with a bottom verdict bar

`obligation-matrix` — many regimes scored on shared obligations in a table

`table` — cells are textual values, not state markers

`checklist` — one set of criteria, not many options against them